

Research Report

Bill Pay Revamp

Landing Page & Features

by **Saad Ahmed**

Interviews

& Testing

About Qualitative Research

Qualitative research (like this study) explores subjective experiences to understand the 'what', 'how' and 'why'.

	QUALITATIVE RESEARCH	QUANTITATIVE RESEARCH
Best for learning	-What do users...? -How do users...? -Why do users...?	-How many users...? -How much...?
Sample Size	-10 to 15 users	-100s and 1000s of users
Statistical significance	-No	-Yes

Sample Size in Qualitative Research

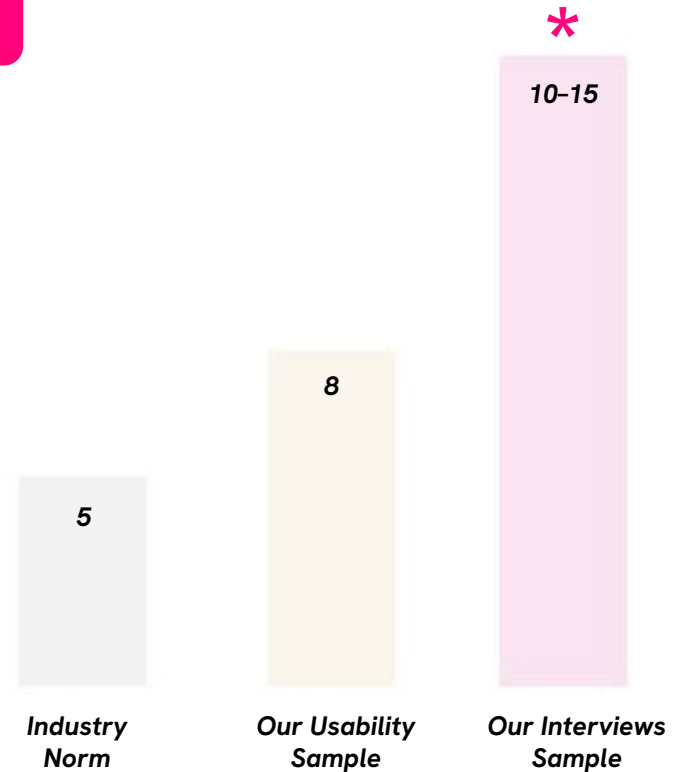
The industry norm for a usability test is to start with 5 participants.

However since our cohorts at Axis are often complex, we observe that we should start with 8 participants.

In the case of interviews, we observe that findings start getting saturated/ repetitive after 10-15 participants.

Qualitative Studies ≠ How Many

Reference: Nielsen Norman Group



Research Goal

1. Understand behaviours, habits & preferences for bill payment
2. Gather feedback on existing landing page
3. Evaluate preferences for the two versions of the redesigned landing page

User Profile and Methodology

- 60-75 minute interviews and moderated user testing was conducted with 5 non-users & 5 users of Bill Pay
- Participants were recruited via a survey on social media as well as word-of-mouth

S. No.	Name	Cohort	open app user?	Employee?
1	Mohit	Bill Pay Non-User	Yes	Yes
2	Aswin	Bill Pay Non-User	Yes	No
3	Ramesh	Bill Pay Non-User	Yes	No
4	Nishant	Bill Pay Non-User	Yes	Yes
5	Dushyant	Bill Pay Non-User	No	No
6	Apoorva	Bill Pay User	Yes	Yes
7	Gopal	Bill Pay User	Yes	Yes
8	Siddhesh	Bill Pay User	Yes	Yes
9	Ganesh	Bill Pay User	Yes	Yes
10	Eshu	Bill Pay User	Yes	Yes

Bill Payments (Channels, Methods, Format)

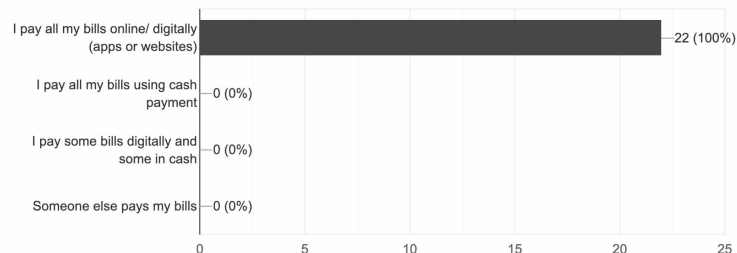
Bill Formats are primarily digital like receiving bills via emails, SMS, or notifications. Preference for payment of bills is also digital.

86% of survey respondents prefer paying bills via UPI apps/ Wallets.

- Those that are using Bill Pay came to know about it from word-of-mouth or are aware due to affinity to the company.
- They use it along with other channels and pay a few utility bills via Bill Pay.

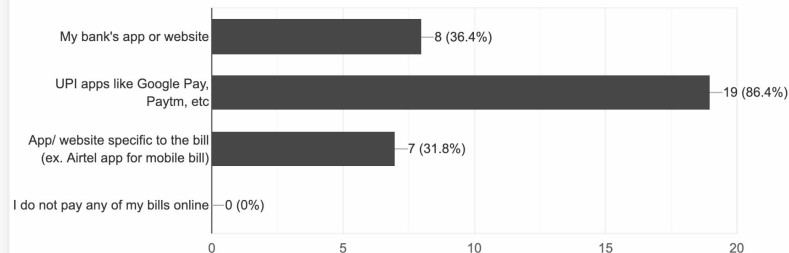
How do you pay your bills/ recharges?

22 responses



When you pay bills online or digitally, which of these do you use?

22 responses



Bill Payments (Channels, Methods, Format)

Participants are habituated to using Wallets and Biller systems the most.

Reasons to prefer Wallets

1. They are dedicated services for bill payments and also feel safer compared to a banking app since accessibility to funds is controlled.
2. They also offer convenience like 'not needing an OTP' which makes payments quicker.

Reasons to prefer Biller App/Website

1. Offer safety by keeping the payment within the ecosystem.
2. It is also a preferred channel for recharges as the user can choose to modify existing plans or discover new ones.[

Reasons to prefer Others

1. Participants prefer to pay credit card bills through either the respective bank apps it is easy to pay via the savings account available in the same bank.
2. Or they prefer CRED since it's an aggregator that also gives rewards and provides helpful usage analytics.

Payment Methods

- While choice of payment method is dictated by channel, most participants prefer UPI since
 - Most billers often redirect to wallets or UPI
 - It is the quickest method of payment

Bill Payments Frustrations

Notifications are often noise than signal

Push notifications often cannot be filtered; important pings get mixed with marketing ones. Hence participants prefer to turn them off except for bills with penalty or consequence if they are missed.

Biller Apps/ Websites might not be always efficient

Wallets or aggregators help in such cases. However some bills (e.g. Rentomojo) cannot be registered into such apps and hence need to be paid through the specific website itself.

Delayed Acknowledgment causes anxiety

In cases like electricity bills, where the payment is acknowledged few days later, participants report feeling anxious and trying to avoid risk of double payment.

Participants majorly rely on habit formation since they have been paying bills since a long time. Major bills especially those that come with a penalty are naturally (and later habitually) top of the mind. Other triggers include:

- a. Salary Credit
- b. A routine date/ week set to pay bills
- c. Someone else's similar payment (flatmate paying rent)

*"I usually get my bills in the first week and I pay them between 10-12th always."
- 55 year old, Secunderabad*

Landing Page Redesign Preference

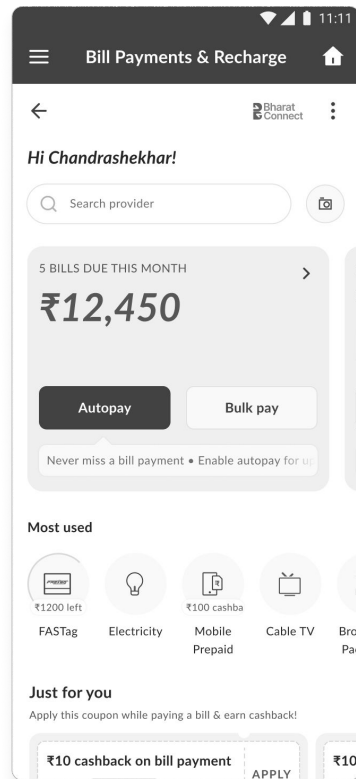
The preference for the redesigned options is mixed.

Those that prefer Option 1 are 'task-first' users.

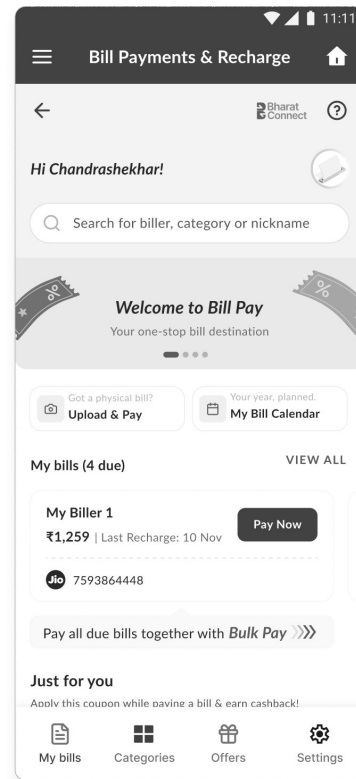
- They come to pay bills quickly, they value density of actionable information, and extra taps feel like friction.
- They prefer that Option 1 prioritises their need for quick payment by reducing clutter and emphasising bills and their payments.

Those that prefer Option 2 are 'emotion-forward' users.

- They prefer feeling at ease before paying bills as the task is overall unfavourable due to spending.
- They prefer that Option 2 feels welcoming due to the banner and copy in the hero section. They find the upfront bulk amount in Option 1 overwhelming and discouraging.



REDESIGNED: OPTION 1
AVG RANK (1.8)

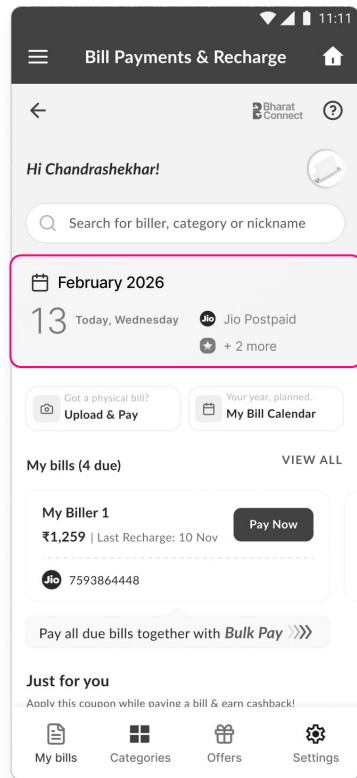


REDESIGNED: OPTION 2
AVG RANK (2)

Hero Section & Popup

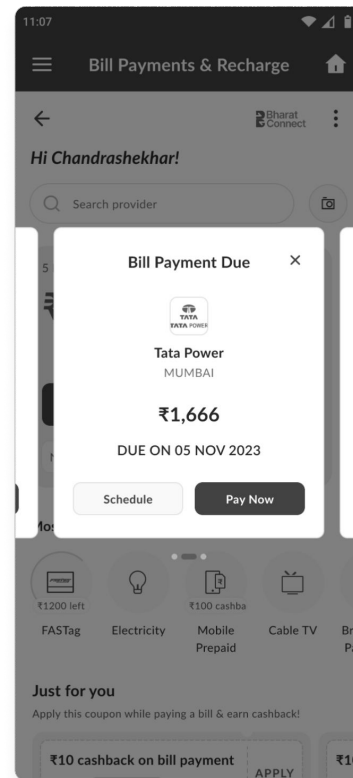
In Option 2, while the hero section creates a positive first impression, the auto-animation speed is too fast to read through slides with substantial content.

The 'date' slide was most confusing as participants did not understand what it conveyed.



OPTION 2: DATE SLIDE IN HERO SECTION

Both kinds of users liked the overlay popup as it made bill payment even quicker by automatically showing the due bills upfront as soon as opened it.



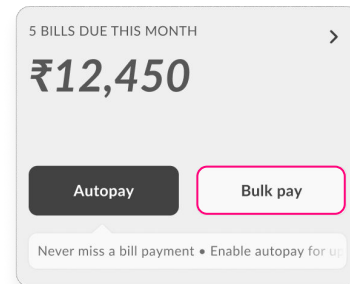
OVERLAY POPUP IN BOTH OPTIONS

Bulk Pay

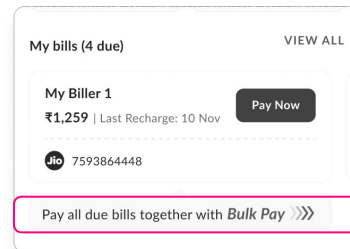
The concept of Bulk Pay was considered useful. Participants preferred Option 1's button as it was easily discoverable over Option 2's text. However,

1. Seeing a bulk amount upfront can be overwhelming and can deter users from using the feature. They would then need to see a breakdown to understand its constitution and verify if each bill is within expected limits.
2. A bulk amount above a certain threshold would not be paid as that money might be needed elsewhere. In such case, participant would prefer prioritising bills and paying only the much-needed ones.

- On average participants pay 4-5 bills a month.
- But paying more than 1 bill at a time depends on
 - i. how many have generated near the same date
 - ii. whether they exist on the same platform
 - iii. bill amount is bearable or not
- Otherwise bills are paid as they get notified; especially smaller size bill amounts.



BULK PAY IN OPTION 1 (PREFERRED)



BULK PAY IN OPTION 2

Autopay Nudges

The autopay nudge is more discoverable in Option 2. But autopay is not a widely preferred feature:

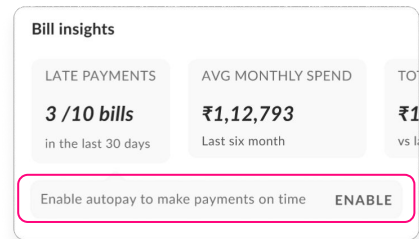
Those that don't prefer autopay

- They use it only when no other payment option is available (ex. setting OTT mandates).
- They instead want to check their bills for any discrepancies and also keep a track whether they are going higher than their usual expenses.
- In some cases they fear it might fail if there is not sufficient balance in the account

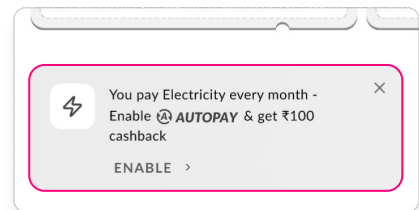
Those that prefer and use it

- They often have set it up for expenses that are consistent i.e. the bill amount does not change much (ex. wifi).
- Users above age 30 seem to be more comfortable with autopay whereas younger users want to be more aware of each bill before payment.

1. In Option 1, the nudge was not correlated to the 'Late Payments' metric as participants perceived the bills to already have been paid (in which case enabling autopay was not needed).



AUTOPAY NUDGE IN OPTION 1

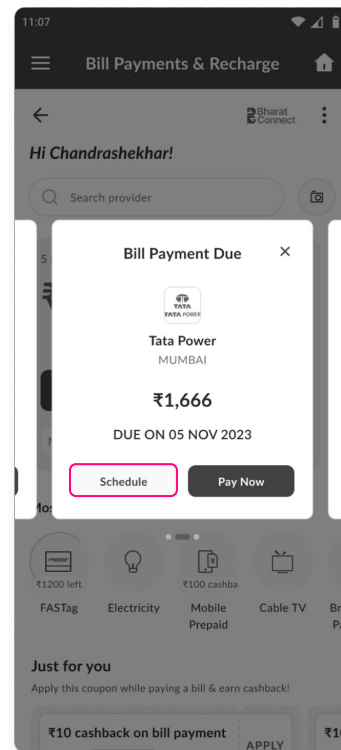


AUTOPAY NUDGE IN OPTION 2 (PREFERRED)

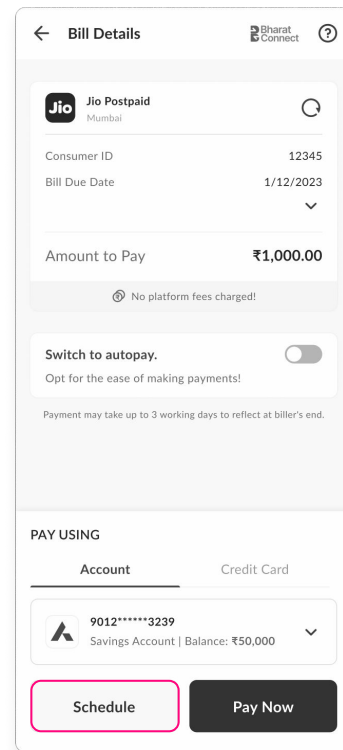
Scheduling & Bill Calendar (1/2)

Schedule is majorly perceived as 'autopay' since scheduling implies that the bill will be paid later which means amount will get debited automatically.

1. Even on clarifying the actual feature offering, the motivation to uptake is low as participants prefer to pay as soon as possible to avoid forgetting.
2. They also have set routines for clearing bills and do not postpone any payments.



'SCHEDULE' IN POPUP



'SCHEDULE' IN PAYMENT FLOW

Scheduling & Bill Calendar (2/2)

The Bill Calendar is easily understood and preferred in Option 1 than Option 2 due to it being upfront rather than nested. But usefulness of feature is mixed:

Those that find it useful

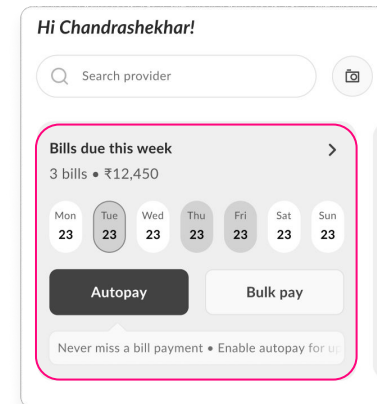
- They prefer the weekly view shown in Option 1 as it serves as reminder of upcoming bills that need to be paid in the immediate future.

Those that don't find it useful

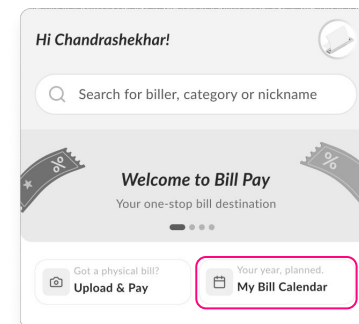
- They do not feel the need to actively check bills and prefer thinking about them as they are generated.

Bill Tracking behaviour:

1. Past bills are checked only for
 - a. Tax purpose
 - b. Tracking expenses
 - c. Failed payment
2. Checking future/ upcoming bills is observed to be low in our sample as participants didn't have a lot of bills that they need to plan for.
 - a. Only one participant would plan bill such that it is calculated in a certain cycle of his credit card.



BILL CALENDAR IN OPTION 1 (PREFERRED)



BILL CALENDAR IN OPTION 2

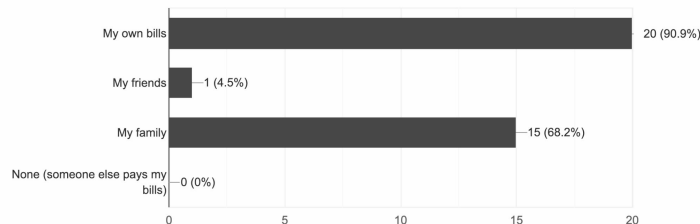
Paying Bills For Others

Around 68% of survey respondents said that they pay their family members' bills along with their own bills. There are 4 types of bill payments observed:

1. **Paying your own bill** (your bill, your money)
 - a. Utilities and recharges often fall here
2. **Assist some else with their bill** (their bill, their money)
 - a. helping parents with bills that they receive like insurance or society bills
3. **Share or split a bill** (combined bill, your or their money)
 - a. Payment for bills when living with family or multiple flatmates as services are shared (ex. Internet, water)
4. **Completely pay someone else's bill** (their bill, your money)
 - a. Payment for family's bills like electricity, fall here. This is often due to parent's low level of tech literacy.

Whose bills do you typically pay?

22 responses



Nicknames & Tags

'Nicknames' are highly understood as participants are already aware about such a feature from other apps.

- Though it is deemed useful to distinguish bills by all, not everyone uses them in real life as they do not have that many bills or do not pay bills for others to need such a feature.

Similarly 'Tags' was considered a useful feature, especially due to the capability of collating/ filtering bills.

- The iteration in Option 2 was better understood due to the microcopy "3 tagged bills" which is missing in Option 1.
- But the **current placement below the fold is not preferred** as participants feel they have to scroll too much to use a very simple feature.
 - Instead they would like it to be integrated in to the 'My Bills' sections as it already has most of the bills.

Mobile Postpaid

Mobile Number

Enter Mobile Number

Biller Nickname (optional)

Enter Nickname

NICKNAME IN BILL PAYMENT FLOW

Your Tags VIEW ALL

Mom Dad Chandrashekhar W

TAGS IN OPTION 1

Your Tags VIEW ALL

M Mom 3 tagged bills H Home 4 tagged bills + Add New

TAGS IN OPTION 2 (PREFERRED)

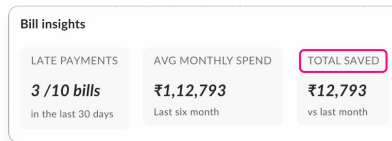
Other features (1/2)

Bill Insights is a consistently valued section. Participants preferred and found the metrics provided in Option 1 more useful.

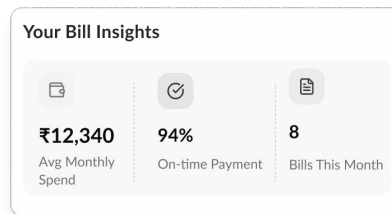
- It was noticed, engaged with, and valued, specifically the **Total saved** metric.
- The **Late payments** metric nudges users to be more vigilant and reduce late payments.
- The **Avg monthly spends** combined with **Total saved** gives a quick financial snapshot of finances. Participants say it helps them track their bill payments by understanding how much they spend, how much they save and whether to optimise.

While the Just For You section was easily discoverable, participants expected coupons and offers to be shown inside the payment flow itself for ease of use.

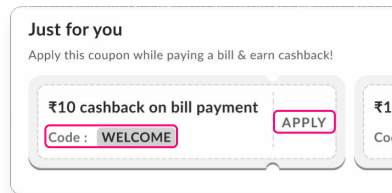
- Participants focused more on the coupon code, often missing the Apply text button.
- In the Current option, the Offers pill button is not noticeable as it is positioned higher than the important sections like due bills.



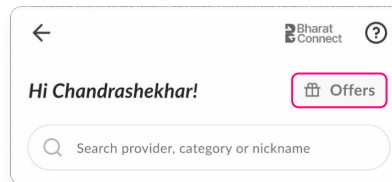
BILL INSIGHTS IN OPTION 1 (PREFERRED)



BILL INSIGHTS IN OPTION 2



JUST FOR YOU SECTION



OFFER PILL BUTTON IN CURRENT OPTION

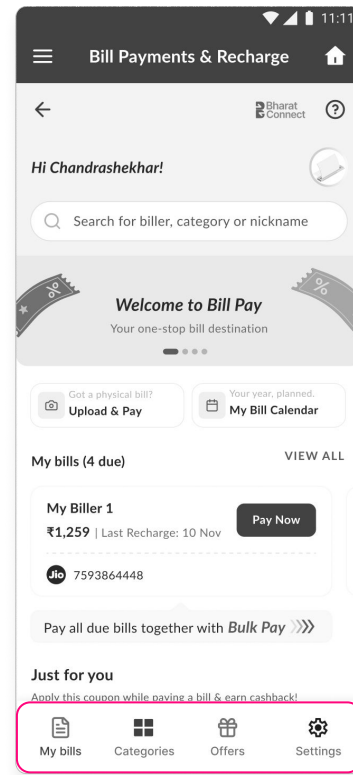
Other features (2/2)

The bottom navigation bar in Option 2 was not easily discoverable by participants themselves.

- They either noticed it at the end of the scroll or when prompted majorly because they were focused on centre of screen and also due to the low fidelity UI.
- It is not seen as a very helpful feature as its components/options are already present in the landing page's scroll which participants can easily access.

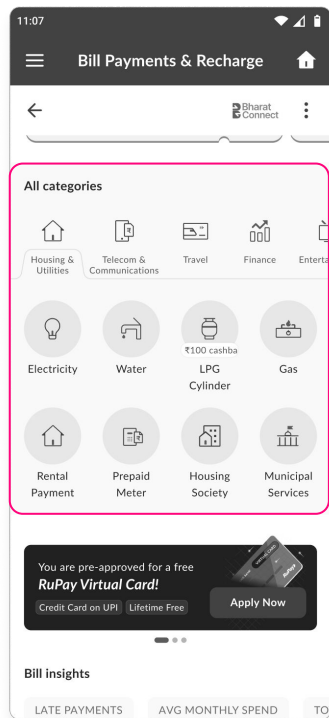
'Customer support' or any option for redressal is seen as a necessity due to possibility of payment failures or other discrepancies.

- Both Option 1 & Option 2 lack such a feature upfront
- Hence participants assumed it to be inside the 'More' menu.

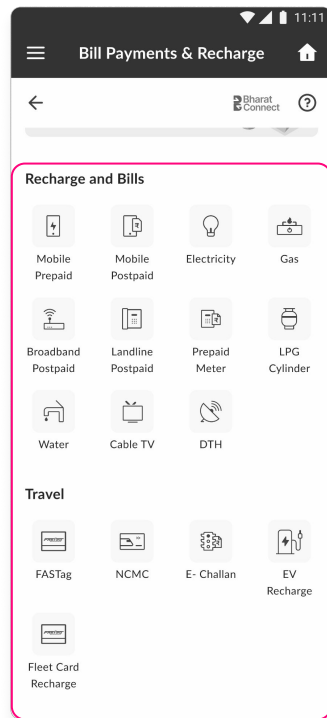


BOTTOM NAVIGATION IN OPTION 2

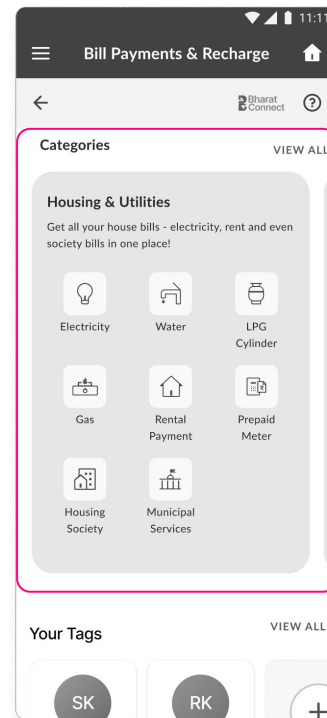
Preference for Categories Layout



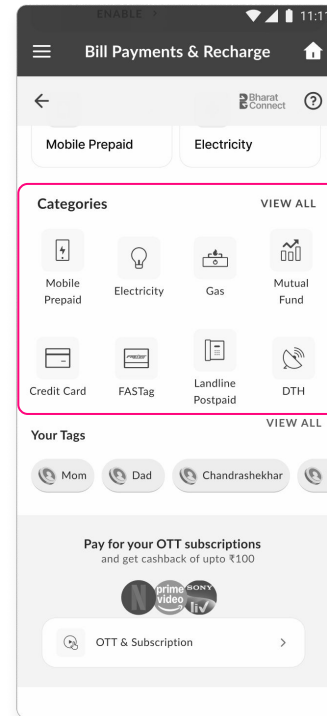
OPTION 1
AVG RANK (1.2)



CURRENT
AVG RANK (2.6)



OPTION 3
AVG RANK (2.8)



OPTION 2
AVG RANK (3.4)

Preference for Categories Layout

Option 1 is most preferred for cognitive ease.

It is simple and it reduces mental effort as categories are immediately visible with can be toggled directly.

'Current' has mixed preference.

Those that prefer it like that it's a simple scroll with clear categorization

Those that do not prefer it much feel the scrolling is too much and the long list increases cognitive overload. The micro animation also feels excessive.

Option 3 has mixed preference but is less preferred than 'Current'

Though the categorisation looks neat, the horizontal interaction of swiping is less preferred.

It also limits direct access to a category increasing the number of swipes required to toggle between them.

Option 2 is least preferred

The progressive disclosure via "View All" is not preferred as it is perceived as an extra navigation step.



Thank You